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APPLICATION NO.	FILING DATE	FIRST NAMED INVENTOR	ATTORNEY DOCKET NO.	CONFIRMATION NO.
18/564,867	11/28/2023	Motohito TAKEZAKI	CRI-54831	5205

97379 7590 07/23/2026

Rankin, Hill & Clark LLP
23755 Lorain Road, Suite 200
North Olmsted, OH 44070

EXAMINER	
PEACE, RHONDA S	

ART UNIT	PAPER NUMBER
2874	

NOTIFICATION DATE	DELIVERY MODE
07/23/2026	ELECTRONIC

Please find below and/or attached an Office communication concerning this application or proceeding.

The time period for reply, if any, is set in the attached communication.

Notice of the Office communication was sent electronically on above-indicated "Notification Date" to the following e-mail address(es):

ishihara@rankinhill.com
millar@rankinhill.com

CORRECTED ***Notice of Allowability***	**Application No.** 18/564,867	**Applicant(s)** TAKEZAKI, Motohito	
	Examiner R. PEACE	**Art Unit** 2874	**AIA (First Inventor to File) Status** Yes

-- The MAILING DATE of this communication appears on the cover sheet with the correspondence address--

All claims being allowable, PROSECUTION ON THE MERITS IS (OR REMAINS) CLOSED in this application. If not included herewith (or previously mailed), a Notice of Allowance (PTOL-85) or other appropriate communication will be mailed in due course. **THIS NOTICE OF ALLOWABILITY IS NOT A GRANT OF PATENT RIGHTS.** This application is subject to withdrawal from issue at the initiative of the Office or upon petition by the applicant. See 37 CFR 1.313 and MPEP 1308.

1. ☑ This communication is responsive to the amendment filed 2/23/26.
   ☐ A declaration(s)/affidavit(s) under **37 CFR 1.130(b)** was/were filed on _____.

2. ☐ An election was made by the applicant in response to a restriction requirement set forth during the interview on _____; the restriction requirement and election have been incorporated into this action.

3. ☑ The allowed claim(s) is/are 1-2,4-20,22 and 24-28 . As a result of the allowed claim(s), you may be eligible to benefit from the **Patent Prosecution Highway** program at a participating intellectual property office for the corresponding application. For more information, please see **http://www.uspto.gov/patents/init_events/pph/index.jsp** or send an inquiry to **PPHfeedback@uspto.gov.**

4. ☑ Acknowledgment is made of a claim for foreign priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a)-(d) or (f).

   Certified copies:

   a) ☑ All b) ☐ Some* c) ☐ None of the:

   1. ☑ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received.
   2. ☐ Certified copies of the priority documents have been received in Application No. _____ .
   3. ☐ Copies of the certified copies of the priority documents have been received in this national stage application from the International Bureau (PCT Rule 17.2(a)).

   * Certified copies not received: _____ .

Applicant has THREE MONTHS FROM THE "MAILING DATE" of this communication to file a reply complying with the requirements noted below. Failure to timely comply will result in ABANDONMENT of this application.
THIS THREE-MONTH PERIOD IS NOT EXTENDABLE.

5. ☐ CORRECTED DRAWINGS (as "replacement sheets") must be submitted.
   ☐ including changes required by the attached Examiner's Amendment / Comment or in the Office action of Paper No./Mail Date _____ .

   Identifying indicia such as the application number (see 37 CFR 1.84(c)) should be written on the drawings in the front (not the back) of each sheet. Replacement sheet(s) should be labeled as such in the header according to 37 CFR 1.121(d).

6. ☐ DEPOSIT OF and/or INFORMATION about the deposit of BIOLOGICAL MATERIAL must be submitted. Note the attached Examiner's comment regarding REQUIREMENT FOR THE DEPOSIT OF BIOLOGICAL MATERIAL.

Attachment(s)

1. ☑ Notice of References Cited (PTO-892)
2. ☑ Information Disclosure Statements (PTO/SB/08), Paper No./Mail Date 7/13/26.
3. ☐ Examiner's Comment Regarding Requirement for Deposit of Biological Material _____.
4. ☐ Interview Summary (PTO-413), Paper No./Mail Date. _____.
5. ☐ Examiner's Amendment/Comment
6. ☑ Examiner's Statement of Reasons for Allowance
7. ☐ Other _____.

/RHONDA S PEACE/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 2874

DETAILED ACTION

Notice of Pre-AIA or AIA Status

The present application, filed on or after March 16, 2013, is being examined under the first inventor to file provisions of the AIA.

Information Disclosure Statement

The information disclosure statement (IDS) submitted on 7/13/26 was filed in compliance with the provisions of 37 CFR 1.97. Accordingly, the information disclosure statement is being considered by the examiner.

Allowable Subject Matter

Claims 1, 2, 4-20, 22, and 24-28 are allowed.

The following is an examiner's statement of reasons for allowance:

Re. Claims 1, 2, 4-6, 22, 24-25, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest an optical fiber assembly, specifically wherein *the ceramics has a hardness lower than a hardness of the optical fiber, and the convex shapes of the optical fibers come into contact with each other and are deformed*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claims 7-11, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest a plate-like ferrule, specifically wherein *the ferrule includes a thin portion where a plate main body formed to have the optical fiber insertion holes has a small thickness, and a thick portion, and guide grooves that communicates with the optical fiber insertion holes are formed in an upper end face of the thick portion, the upper end face contacting with the thin portion*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claim 12, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest an optical module, specifically wherein *the ceramics has a hardness lower than a hardness of the optical fiber, and the convex shapes of the optical fibers come into contact with each other and are deformed*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claims 13-20, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest a ferrule in an optical fiber assembly in which distal ends of the optical fibers protrude from a polished surface at a connection end face of the ferrule to enable physical contact connection, specifically wherein *the ferrule has a hardness of no more than 8.0 GPa, which is lower than a hardness of the optical fibers to be inserted in the optical fiber insertion holes*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claim 26, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest an optical connector, specifically wherein *the ceramics has a hardness lower than a hardness of the optical fiber, and the convex shapes of the optical fibers come into contact with each other and are deformed*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claim 27, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest a method of forming the connection end face of the optical fiber assembly, specifically wherein *the ceramics has a hardness lower than a hardness of the optical fiber, and the convex shapes of the optical fibers come into contact with each other and are deformed*, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

Re. Claim 28, the prior art does not disclose or reasonably suggest a method of manufacturing an optical fiber assembly, specifically wherein *the plate main body is made of ceramics and the optical fibers have a hardness harder than the plate body*, the method specifically comprising *an adhesive adjusting step of orienting distal ends of the*

inserted optical fibers upward to allow the adhesive adhering the optical fibers to be returned to a side of the optical fiber insertion holes; a curing step of curing the adhesive adjusted in the adhesive adjusting step; and a polishing step of optically polishing the side of the connection end surface of the plate main body to allow physical contact connection, in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims.

The most applicable prior art, Lange et al. (US 2005/0069265 A1), discussed in the Office Action mailed 10/30/25, fails to disclose or reasonably suggest the claimed invention, specifically those portions *highlighted* above in combination with the remaining limitations of the claims. Applicant's arguments filed 2/23/26 are persuasive.

Any comments considered necessary by applicant must be submitted no later than the payment of the issue fee and, to avoid processing delays, should preferably accompany the issue fee. Such submissions should be clearly labeled "Comments on Statement of Reasons for Allowance."

Conclusion

Any inquiry concerning this communication or earlier communications from the examiner should be directed to R. PEACE whose telephone number is (571)272-8580. The examiner can normally be reached 9-5 pm.

Examiner interviews are available via telephone, in-person, and video conferencing using a USPTO supplied web-based collaboration tool. To schedule an interview, applicant is encouraged to use the USPTO Automated Interview Request (AIR) at http://www.uspto.gov/interviewpractice.

If attempts to reach the examiner by telephone are unsuccessful, the examiner's supervisor, Uyen-Chau Le can be reached at (571) 272-2397. The fax phone number for the organization where this application or proceeding is assigned is 571-273-8300.

Information regarding the status of published or unpublished applications may be obtained from Patent Center. Unpublished application information in Patent Center is available to registered users. To file and manage patent submissions in Patent Center, visit: https://patentcenter.uspto.gov. Visit https://www.uspto.gov/patents/apply/patent-center for more information about Patent Center and https://www.uspto.gov/patents/docx for information about filing in DOCX format. For additional questions, contact the Electronic Business Center (EBC) at 866-217-9197 (toll-free). If you would like assistance from a USPTO Customer Service Representative, call 800-786-9199 (IN USA OR CANADA) or 571-272-1000.

/RHONDA S PEACE/
Primary Examiner, Art Unit 2874
7/21/26